

Title

Protocol for Evaluating the Optimal Duration of Anticoagulation in Cancer Patients With Low-Risk Thromboembolic Events: A Stratified Randomized Study Design

Abstract

Cancer-associated thromboembolism represents a major morbidity risk, yet optimal anticoagulation duration in low-risk presentations remains uncertain. This protocol describes a randomized comparison of prolonged versus standard-duration anticoagulation in cancer patients with hemodynamically stable pulmonary embolism, stratified by functional status. Eligible participants will be randomly assigned to receive either 18 months or 6 months of oral anticoagulant therapy. Study stratification will account for performance status (fully active vs. restricted activity), as this parameter may modify the risk-benefit profile of extended treatment. Primary outcome will be objectively documented recurrent thrombosis. Secondary outcomes will include bleeding complications graded by severity and major adverse events. Enrollment targets approximately 200 participants across both strata. Baseline characteristics, concurrent cancer treatments, and adherence will be evaluated as potential effect modifiers. Study assessments will occur at regular intervals throughout treatment and at a final safety follow-up visit.